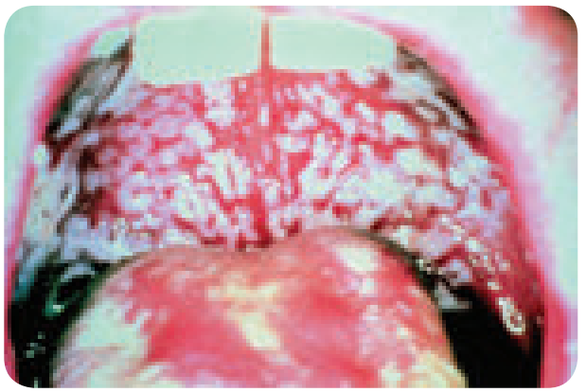


Figure 9.9: Oral candidiasis

cavity (oral thrush) infection on the buccal mucosa, gums, tongue, reddening of the mucous membrane gives dry, smooth metallic taste and burning at the local site (Figure 9.9).

ii. Alimentary Candidiasis – *Candida* colonizes on the oesophagus causing oesophagitis. It is mostly asymptomatic or it may cause burning pain in the epigastrium or throat.

b. Cutaneous Dermatitis

i. Diaper Dermatitis – *Candida* colonize on the cutaneous layer causes cutaneous Candidiasis leads to maculopapules vesicles with erythematous rash. This is common among infants and known as **Diaper rash**.

ii. Intertrigo – This is an **i**nflammatory lesion of the skin folds due to candidal infection.

c. Systemic Involvement

The *Candida* colonizes in various organs and causes various manifestations through the blood stream. Clinical features are found to be Urinary tract C**andidiasis, Candiduria, Endocarditis, Pulmonary Candidiasis, Arthritis, Osteomyelitis, Meningitis, Candidemia** and **Septicemia.**

2. Allergic Diseases

Allergic manifestation is caused due to the metabolites of *Candida*. The cutaneous allergies are **urticaria** and **eczema**, and **bronchial asthma**.

Laboratory Diagnosis

i. Samples

Specimens collected are mucous membrane from the mouth, vagina, skin and sputum based on the site of involvement.

a. Direct Examination

Gram staining LPCB, and KOH wet mount are used to visualize the yeast cells.

Presence of yeast cells approximately 4.8 µm with budding and pseudo hyphae are observed. Other stains like periodic acid - Schiff stain and Gomori's methylamine silver stain are also used to observe the fungal elements in tissue.

b. Fungal culture

The clinical specimens can be cultured on Sabouraud dextrose agar (SDA) with antibiotics and incubated at 25°C and 37°C (Figure 9.10). The colonies appear in 3–4 days as cream coloured, smooth and pasty.

The some of the species of *Candida* are *Candida albicans, Candida tropicalis, Candida krusei* and *Candida glabrata*.

ii. Special Test

Germ tube test

The culture of Candida species is treated with sheep or normal human serum and inoculated at 37°C for 2 to 4 hours. A drop of suspension is examined on the slide. The germ tubes are seen as long tube–like projections extending from

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